

DAVID O'NEAL

GRC Engineering | AI Security & Governance | Security Operations

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with 8+ years across security operations, compliance implementation, and vulnerability management in financial services, government, aerospace, and industrial environments. Consistently built repeatable security processes through automation, and over the last two years shifted toward building them in code.

At Bank OZK, investigated phishing, malware, BEC, and DLP incidents daily, tuning detection rules across Proofpoint, Microsoft Defender, and Cisco SEG, cutting false positives by 40%. At Legato Security, cut critical vulnerability remediation from several weeks to under 72 hours across 279+ endpoints, built a Patching-as-a-Service framework, and coordinated security engineering delivery across 10+ enterprise accounts.

Building the Compliance Automation Lab in Python and Terraform at gitlab.com/doneal78-group, a live GRC engineering portfolio with controls defined in code, evidence collection automated from APIs, and compliance posture continuously monitored. Also built OracleRecon Shield, an AI-powered risk assessment platform on the Gemini API. Targeting GRC Engineering and AI security roles. M.S. in Cybersecurity from Maryville University.

Certifications: GRC Foundations in Cybersecurity; PSAA (In Progress); SOAR Analyst, Google Cloud Siemplify; VMDR, Qualys; Chronicle SIEM Fundamentals; Level 1 Cyber Threat Hunting Training

Frameworks: NIST 800-53, NIST AI RMF, ISO 27001, SOC 2, Risk Management Frameworks

AI Technical: Python automation, Google Gemini API integration, prompt engineering, local LLM tools (Ollama), agentic workflow design

AI GRC: AI-assisted risk assessment, LLM-assisted policy drafting, Policy-as-Code, AI governance for SMBs

CORE COMPETENCIES

GRC & Compliance: NIST 800-53, NIST AI RMF, ISO 27001, SOC 2, Control Mapping, Audit Support, SOP Development, Risk Management Frameworks

AI Security & Governance: AI Risk Assessment, AI Risk Management, Gemini API Integration, Prompt Engineering, LLM-assisted Policy Generation

Security Automation: Python, Flask, CLI Tools, boto3, Compliance-as-Code, Infrastructure-as-Code, Policy-as-Code, CI/CD Security, Terraform, GitHub Actions

Cloud Security: AWS Security Hub, CSPM (FSBP / CIS), CloudTrail, AWS Config, IAM, S3, Vulnerability Management Lifecycle

Security Operations: SOC Analysis, Detection Tuning, Incident Response, Log Analysis, Threat Hunting, SOAR, IAM Administration

SIEM & Tooling: Splunk, Sentinel, Chronicle, Defender, CrowdStrike, Proofpoint, Tenable.io, Nessus, PDQ Deploy, Jira

EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Consultant

Apr 2025 - Present

Legato Security | Remote

- Redesigned vulnerability remediation workflows and automated patch deployment across 279+ endpoints in regulated aerospace and industrial environments, cutting critical remediation from several weeks to under 72 hours. More than 80% faster.
- Built a Patching-as-a-Service delivery framework that standardized remediation across client environments and developed governance documentation supporting regulatory requirements for regulated clients.
- Designed technical onboarding workflows in GuideCX and built the connector integration framework for Mave, giving engineers a documented, repeatable process across 10+ enterprise security accounts.
- Coordinated cross-functional security engineering delivery across SOC analysts, engineers, and channel partners; produced executive-facing reporting translating technical work into plain language for client leadership.

State IT Security Specialist

Oct 2024 - Mar 2025

Arkansas Department of Public Safety | Little Rock, AR

- Led NIST 800-53 control assessments for state IT systems, identified compliance gaps, and worked directly with system owners on corrective action plans and supporting documentation.
- Maintained patch compliance above 95% across 500+ endpoints and administered IAM in Active Directory and Azure AD to enforce least-privilege access.
- Collected audit evidence and prepared compliance documentation that directly supported state regulatory authorization responses.

SOC Analyst

Oct 2021 - Jun 2024

Bank OZK | Little Rock, AR

- Investigated and resolved 30+ phishing, malware, BEC, and DLP incidents per week in a financial-sector SOC, completing phishing investigations in under 20 minutes while maintaining response SLAs.
- Reduced phishing false-positive alerts by 40% through detection rule tuning across Proofpoint, Microsoft Defender, and Cisco Secure Email Gateway, giving the team cleaner signal on real threats.
- Developed DLP incident response procedures that standardized investigations, reduced analyst decision-making time, and improved traceability across the team.

System Operations Analyst I

Jun 2017 - Oct 2021

FIS Global | Little Rock, AR

- Monitored enterprise financial systems using Splunk, responded to service disruptions in real time, and supported root cause investigations.
- Maintained operational playbooks supporting SLA consistency and regulatory compliance across a large fintech environment.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

OracleRecon Shield | oracle-recon-insight.lovable.app

AI-powered SMB risk assessment platform built on Google Gemini 2.5 Flash. Business owners answer 25 questions across 6 security domains and receive a risk grade, prioritized vulnerabilities, and a remediation roadmap, cutting assessment time from several days to under 30 minutes. Concept to live in under 8 hours, built solo.

Compliance Automation Lab | gitlab.com/doneal78-group

Present

A live GRC engineering build following AJ Yawn GRC Engineering for AWS curriculum, at gitlab.com/doneal78-group. Started by automating the manual work: four Python tools covering control mapping across NIST 800-53, ISO 27001, and SOC 2; automatic risk scoring in a Flask web app; a compliance evidence collector that pulls audit artifacts from APIs rather than chasing control owners; and an AI policy generator running through Ollama. From there, moved into infrastructure: a boto3 AWS Config compliance checker, then a Terraform baseline that moved a live account from 40% AT RISK to 78% NEEDS IMPROVEMENT. Security Hub CSPM followed with FSBP and CIS v1.2.0. The GRC Engineering Club weekly challenges extended the build: a GitHub Actions CI/CD gate that blocks non-compliant configs before merge, Cosign keyless signing with tamper verification on infrastructure artifacts, and a NIST 800-53 Rev 5 baseline deployed into a live Security Hub account alongside existing standards. Built in public on LinkedIn.

Cybersecurity Home Lab | TCM Security PSAA Capstone

Jan 2025 - Present

VirtualBox lab with Windows and Ubuntu workstations standing in for a small enterprise network. Working through the TCM Security PSAA curriculum for hands-on IR, log analysis, and detection engineering outside of work.

EDUCATION

MARYVILLE UNIVERSITY OF SAINT LOUIS, ONLINE/REMOTE

M.S., Cybersecurity, 2021 | Cum Laude

UNIVERSITY OF ARKANSAS GRANTHAM, ONLINE/REMOTE

B.S., Information Technology, 2019

UNIVERSITY OF ARKANSAS PULASKI TECHNICAL COLLEGE

A.S., Computer Information Systems, 2017